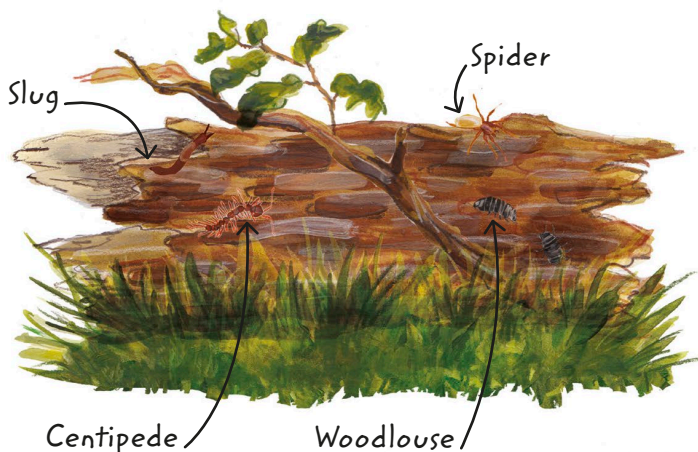


Life in a log

A fallen log might look dead, but in fact it is teeming with life. Home to all sorts of different tiny animals, plants, lichens, and fungi, logs also provide a safe place for seedlings to grow. This is why they are sometimes called “nurse logs.”



Newly fallen

Once a log falls, slugs and woodlice are among the first creatures to find shelter in the dark, moist places beneath it. They feed on decaying plants, and centipedes and spiders follow to eat them!

One year old

After one year, new creatures have moved in. Bark bugs live beneath the bark, while beetles drill holes to lay their eggs in. Their larvae eat the rotting wood. Mosses and fungi, such as ink cap mushrooms, appear on the log's surface.

